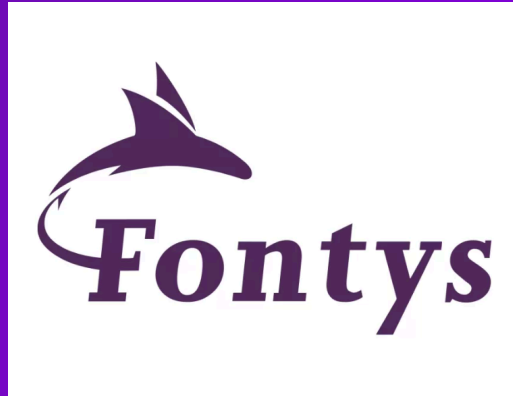




Housing Guide for International Students

Step-by-Step Guide to Finding Accommodation in the Netherlands

Fontys Global Guide

December 2025

Table of Contents

	Introduction	1
1	Step 1: Apply Early for Fontys-Arranged Accommodation	2
2	Step 2: Use Reliable Housing Platforms (Start Searching Early)	3
3	Step 3: Broaden Your Search Area and Leverage Networks	4
4	Step 4: Beware of Scams and Pitfalls	5
5	Step 5: Finalize Your Rental Legally and Logistically	6

Introduction

Finding student accommodation in the Netherlands can be challenging and competitive, especially in popular student cities. Fontys University has campuses in **Eindhoven, Tilburg, and Venlo** (the three largest Fontys locations), and all these cities face a tight housing market.

Start your housing search early – ideally as soon as you are admitted – because the Netherlands is dealing with a severe student housing shortage. In fact, Dutch institutions warn not to come without arranging a room in advance, since finding one on short notice can be extremely difficult.

This guide will walk you through the steps to secure accommodation safely and successfully, with reliable resources and tips to help first-year international students at Fontys avoid common pitfalls (like scams) and find a suitable place to live.



Start Early

Begin your search months in advance



Be Thorough

Check multiple platforms and networks



Stay Safe

Beware of scams and verify everything

1

Apply Early for Fontys-Arranged Accommodation

Fontys does not have its own dormitories, but it cooperates with trusted landlords and agencies to offer a limited number of rooms to first-year international students. If you live abroad and are enrolling in an English-taught Fontys program, you likely qualify to apply for housing through Fontys (via an online accommodation form). Do this as soon as possible after your (conditional) admission. Keep in mind: applying through Fontys does not guarantee a room, due to the limited supply. Rooms are allotted after the deadline among eligible applicants, so it's more of a lottery than a reservation. Still, it's an opportunity you should not miss.

Know the Deadlines

Fontys' housing application deadlines are 15 June for a September (Fall) start, or 8 December for a February (Spring) start. Submit the accommodation request before these dates, or you will lose the chance for Fontys-arranged housing. (For example, if starting studies in Fall, apply by spring/summer; if starting in February, apply by early December of the previous year.) Fontys opens the housing request form on 1 May (for Fall intake) and 1 October (for Spring intake) in many cases, so mark your calendar and apply early – rooms are first-come-first-served among those who meet all criteria by the deadline. After you apply, Fontys will confirm receipt and, only after the deadline, let you know if you have been offered a room.

Prepare for Arrival

If you get a Fontys-arranged room, you'll be informed which housing agency is providing it (about 4 weeks before classes start). You will need to pay the rent plus deposit in advance to secure the room. Note that a Fontys-arranged contract is usually for the first academic year (or semester for exchange students). You must accept and pay for the whole period offered. If you prefer to move out after that first year, you'll arrange housing on your own for the later years.

Have a Plan B

Because not everyone gets a Fontys room, do not rely solely on the university housing offer. Fontys strongly recommends continuing your own housing search in parallel. In the worst case that you cannot secure any accommodation by the time of your move, Fontys advises postponing travel rather than arriving without housing. It's harsh, but it underscores how critical it is to have a room before you land in the Netherlands.

2

Use Reliable Housing Platforms (Start Searching Early)

If Fontys housing is full or if you prefer arranging your own place, you'll need to dive into the private housing market. In Dutch student cities, start searching as early as possible – months in advance – because the competition is intense. Here are trusted platforms and strategies to help you find a room or apartment:



Fontys/Local Housing Office

First, check if your campus city has any official or recommended housing services. For example, Eindhoven students can look at Vestide, the student housing corporation in that city. Each city often has a similar organization or university partnership (e.g. Tilburg has SSH/TalentSquare residences, Venlo

has some reserved student apartments). Contact Fontys student services to ask about any local housing options for your campus.

Register on ROOM.nl

ROOM.nl is a central platform for non-profit student housing corporations (covering cities like Amsterdam, Utrecht, Delft, Leiden, etc., and some in Brabant/Limburg). You can register on ROOM.nl for a small fee and start accruing waiting time. Housing on this platform is allocated based on how long you've been registered (longer = higher priority). As an international first-year, you might get a priority listing in some cities, meaning certain rooms are set aside for new internationals.

[Visit website →](#)

Kamernet

Kamernet is one of the largest student housing platforms in the Netherlands, with thousands of room listings across all major cities. Most student rooms (especially sublets or shared houses) are advertised here. You'll need to buy a subscription (e.g. monthly) to respond to ads, but it's a widely-used service. Kamernet even offers a 'room guarantee' refund if you don't find a room within 4 months. Many international students start with Kamernet because of its huge offering.

[Visit website →](#)

Huurwoningen

Huurwoningen.nl is a broad rental platform that is often recommended for international students. It focuses on the private rental market (rooms, studios, apartments) and is more English-friendly. A benefit is you can try it with a free 14-day premium account, allowing you to respond to listings without immediate payment.

[Visit website →](#)

HousingAnywhere

HousingAnywhere.com is an international housing platform popular for short-term stays and sublets (often furnished). It partners with universities and offers a secure booking system. If you need a place for just a few months (or to start with while you keep searching on-site), this is a safe option.

[Visit website →](#)

Pararius and Funda

These are general Dutch housing search engines (more geared to apartments and studios in the private sector). Pararius.com is English-friendly and lists properties from many real estate agencies. Funda.nl is another (mostly in Dutch) platform primarily for buying houses, but it has a rentals section too.

[Pararius →](#) [Funda →](#)

Be Quick and Proactive

On all these platforms, speed and persistence are key. Attractive listings (especially affordable rooms) can receive hundreds of responses within an hour of going online. Set up email alerts or use apps to notify you the moment a new room is posted. If you can respond within minutes of a listing going live, you greatly increase your odds of getting invited for a viewing.

Consider Renting Together

If you're struggling to find an individual room, another strategy is to team up with fellow students to rent a place. For instance, a group of 2-3 students can together rent a two or three-bedroom apartment that might be above one person's budget but affordable when split.

3

Broaden Your Search Area and Leverage Networks

Don't limit your hunt to one website or one neighborhood. To maximize your chances:



Expand to Nearby Towns

While you'll of course search in your campus city (Eindhoven, Tilburg, or Venlo, for example), also consider nearby towns or suburbs within reasonable commuting distance. Often, smaller towns around a big city have lower demand and more available rooms. For example, if you study in Eindhoven, you might look at Helmond, Veldhoven, or other places 15–30 minutes away; for Tilburg, you could consider Breda, Oisterwijk, or even 's-Hertogenbosch (Den Bosch) by train; for Venlo, you might search in Venray or other Limburg villages, even just across the German border.

Use Your Social Networks

Personal connections can be gold. Let people know you're looking for housing. If you have friends or acquaintances already studying at Fontys (or other Dutch universities), ask if they know of available rooms or tips. Sometimes outgoing students (e.g., graduating or exchange students leaving) will pass their room to a new student informally – being in the loop can help you snag these openings.

Facebook Groups & Online Communities

Many student cities have active housing groups on Facebook where rooms are posted. Join groups like 'Rooms in Eindhoven', 'Kamers in Tilburg', 'Student Housing in Venlo' etc., as well as broader ones like 'Find a room(mate) in the Netherlands'. Posts on these groups often come from students who have a room to sublet or landlords looking specifically for students.

Student Forums and Discord

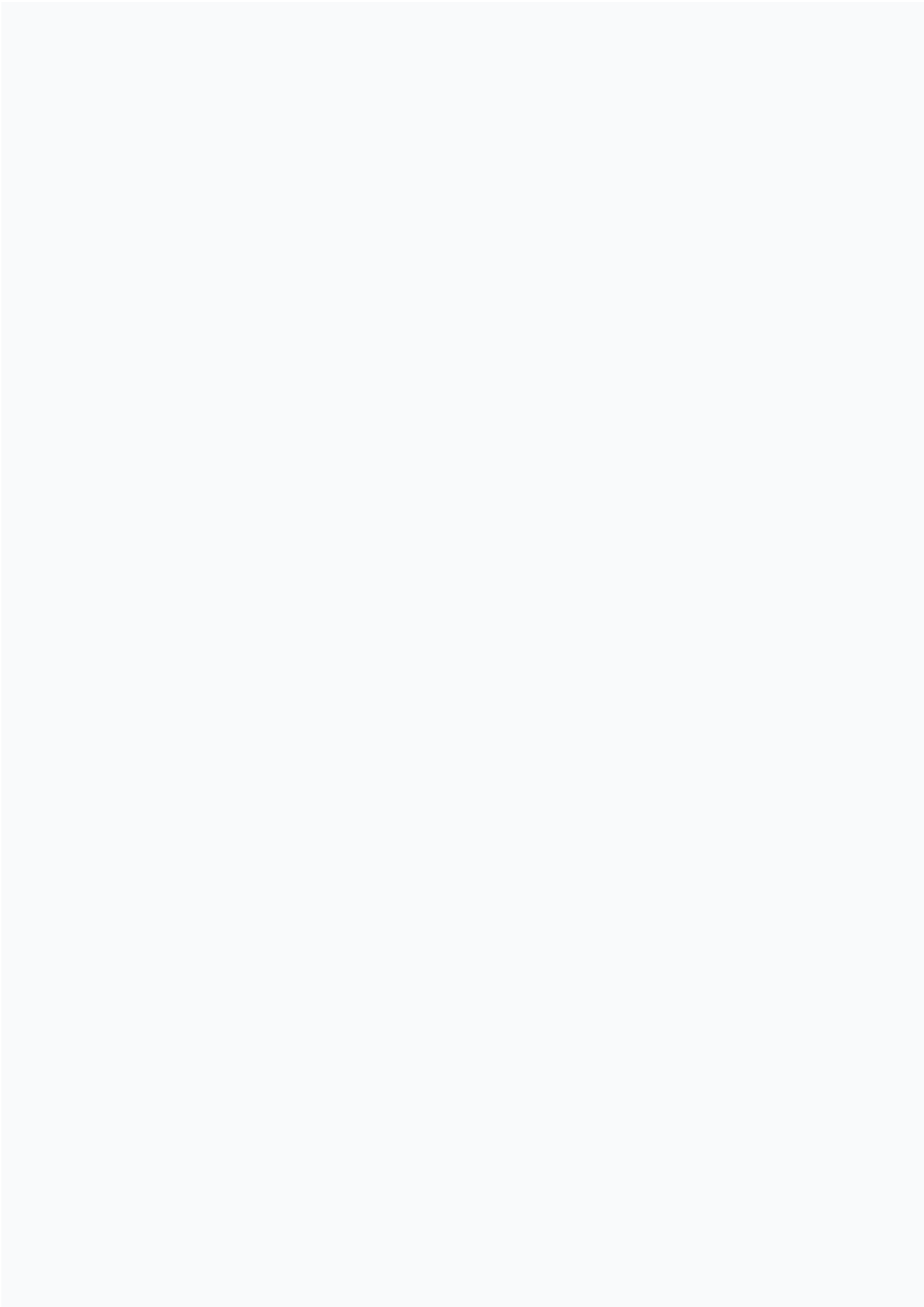
The international student community in the Netherlands is very active online. The r/StudyInTheNetherlands subreddit (on Reddit) and associated Discord server are full of students exchanging housing advice and even posting listings. Consider joining these communities – you might pick up insider tips or even find roommates to team up with.

Student Organizations

Leverage organizations like Erasmus Student Network (ESN) or other international student clubs at Fontys. They often have housing boards or at least can connect you with senior students. For example, ESN Tilburg has a housing marketplace on Facebook, and other cities have similar initiatives.

University Housing Office

If you're really struggling, don't hesitate to reach out to Fontys's Student Administration International (email: internationalstudents@fontys.nl). They may not find a room for you, but they can guide you, and sometimes they know of last-minute cancellations in Fontys reserved housing or trusted housing agencies to try.



4

Beware of Scams and Pitfalls

Unfortunately, the housing shortage has led to scammers preying on desperate students, so you must stay vigilant. Common housing scams include fake listings to steal your money, or illegal rentals that leave you unregistered. Here's how to protect yourself:



Never Pay Before You See (or Verify) the Room

A huge red flag is any landlord who demands a deposit or rent before you've even seen the room or signed a contract. Scammers often pressure students to transfer money upfront ('to secure the room') and then disappear. Do not send money for a room you haven't seen in person or via a live video tour, no matter how 'perfect' it looks.



Municipal Registration Test

In the Netherlands, you must register your address with the municipality (city hall) if you'll live there for over 4 months. A very important tip: always ask if you can register at that address. If the answer is 'no' or hesitation, walk away – it's likely a scam or illegal sublet. Being unregistered has serious consequences: you won't get your BSN (citizen service number) which you need for almost everything.



No 'Agency Fees' to Tenants

Another common trap is bogus fees. In the Netherlands, if you find a room through an agency or platform, you should not pay 'broker' or 'commission' fees to the landlord/agent. It is illegal for an agent to charge tenants for simply offering a listing. You will typically need to pay a security deposit (borg) –

usually equal to 1 month rent (sometimes 2 months at most) – but that should be outlined in a contract.



Too Good to Be True? Probably Is

If you see a listing for a large, beautiful room in the city center at an insanely low rent, or a landlord who immediately offers to send you the keys by mail without meeting you – those are huge red flags. Scammers often entice with great deals and a sob story. Stay critical and trust your instincts.



Use Safe Payment Methods

Do not pay in cash without proper receipts, and avoid wire services like Western Union for rent. The safest is to pay via bank transfer after signing the contract (so there's a paper trail). If you're paying a private individual, try to confirm their identity matches the bank account name or the property ownership.

5

Finalize Your Rental Legally and Logistically

Once you find a potential room and the landlord (or agency) has chosen you as the tenant, congratulations – but your work isn't done yet. Make sure to handle the formalities properly so that your stay in the Netherlands will be smooth:

Read the Contract Thoroughly

Before signing any rental agreement, read every clause carefully (even the fine print). Verify that the contract includes essential details: your name, the landlord's name and address, the address of the rental, start date, end date (or notice period terms if it's an open-ended contract), monthly rent, what's included (e.g. utilities, furniture), the deposit amount, and any rules.

Check What's Included

Confirm which bills and amenities are included in your rent. Commonly, Dutch rentals might include 'G/W/L' (gas, water, electricity) and internet in the rent, or they might be separate. If not included, factor those costs into your budget. The average student room rent is around €550 per month in the Netherlands (depending on city), but big cities can be higher.

Paying the Deposit and Rent

When everything looks good and you're ready to sign, you'll typically pay the security deposit (usually one month's rent) plus the first month's rent upfront. Make sure to get a signed receipt or confirmation of any payments. It's best to do a bank transfer so there is a record; avoid handing over cash. Once you move in, keep proof of the condition of the room (take photos), so when you move out you can reclaim your deposit.

Register at the Municipality

As soon as you have a signed rental contract and arrive in the Netherlands, register with the local municipality (gemeente) at your new address. This is required if you'll be living in the Netherlands for more than 4 months. After registering, you'll receive your BSN (Citizen Service Number), which is essential for things like opening a bank account, getting health insurance, and even getting paid for a part-time job.

Know Your Tenant Rights and Support Resources

Dutch rental laws offer protections for tenants, including international students. If you encounter problems with your accommodation, Fontys's student housing officer or student desk can advise you. Additionally, you can reach out to the Housing Hotline run by the Dutch Student Union (LSVb). They help international students with housing issues and can even intervene or guide you on legal steps.

Stay Safe and Settle In

With your housing sorted and paperwork done, you can finally focus on settling into student life! On arrival, meet your roommates or landlord and establish a good relationship by communicating openly. Most Dutch student houses have a friendly, communal culture, so don't be shy to join a dinner or activity – it's a great way to make friends.

Important Resources

Fontys Student Administration International

internationalstudents@fontys.nl

Study in NL Official Housing Guide

www.studyinnl.org →

[r/StudyInTheNetherlands \(Reddit Community\)](#)

[Visit community →](#)

Sources & Further Reading

This guide is based on verified information from Fontys University's official housing information, the Dutch government's Study in NL resources, and experienced student communities. For the latest updates and detailed information, please consult:

- Fontys University official accommodation page
- Study in NL website (www.studyinnl.org)
- International student housing guide and community forums
- Dutch Student Union (LSVb) Housing Hotline

Good luck with your housing search and welcome to the Netherlands!

Remember: Always use trusted sources and stay alert. You've got this! 🏠

Fontys Global Guide • December 2025

This guide is for informational purposes. Always verify current information with official Fontys sources.